

Lesson 18 Practice: Answers and Rationales

JKSSB Computer Awareness

October 8, 2026

Provenance: All 20 items are original JKSSB-pattern questions (*[Original]*); none reproduces an official paper item.

- Q1. B.** Software is a set of programs or instructions that tell the computer what to do. A describes hardware; C wrongly narrows software to the operating system; D describes data, not programs.
- Q2. B.** The operating system is system software because it manages the hardware. MS Word (A) and a payroll package (C) are application software; a media player (D) is ordinarily treated as application software.
- Q3. B.** OS stands for Operating System. A (Open Source) is a licensing term; C and D are not the correct expansions.
- Q4. C.** MS Excel is application software because it helps the user perform a task. A device driver (A), the operating system (B), and the BIOS (D) are all system software.
- Q5. A.** An antivirus program performs the maintenance task of scanning for and removing viruses, so it is utility software. A web browser (B) and MS PowerPoint (C) are application software; a compiler (D) is programming software (language translator).
- Q6. A.** IDE stands for Integrated Development Environment, which combines an editor, a compiler or interpreter, and a debugger. B, C, and D are not the correct expansions.
- Q7. B.** Compilers, interpreters, and assemblers are language translators, so they are programming software. They are not application software (A), not utility software (C), and not embedded software (D).
- Q8. B.** Software stored inside a device to control that device is embedded software, usually held as firmware. Application software (A) is for user tasks; freeware (C) is a licensing model, not a device role; middleware (D) connects systems.
- Q9. A.** Middleware connects different applications and systems and sits between the operating system and application software, offering services such as messaging and authentication. B describes cabling; C describes shareware; D describes hardware.
- Q10. C.** MS Word is application software, so it is not system software. The operating system (A), a device driver (B), and the BIOS (D) are all system software.
- Q11. B.** Open-source gives access to the source code, freeware is free of cost but may keep its source closed, and shareware is a trial that later requires payment. A merges all three; C falsely equates freeware with open-source and calls shareware free forever; D equates open-source with shareware.

- Q12. B.** Open-source software publishes its source code and permits viewing, modification, and redistribution under its licence. A describes only price, not source availability; C describes shareware; D describes public-domain software.
- Q13. A.** Freeware is distributed free of cost, but its source code may remain closed. B wrongly claims the source is always included; C describes shareware; D is incorrect because freeware still has an owner and a licence.
- Q14. B.** Shareware is offered as a limited trial and requires payment for continued or full use. A describes open-source/free software; C describes system software; D confuses shareware with public-domain software.
- Q15. B.** Public-domain software has no copyright and may be used freely. A is the opposite; C describes shareware; D describes proprietary software that needs activation.
- Q16. B.** Statements I and III are correct: an operating system is system software, and shareware is usually a trial version. Statement II is false because freeware (free of cost) is not the same as open-source (source code available). A includes false II; C omits I and includes false II; D includes false II.
- Q17. B.** GPL stands for GNU General Public License. A is incomplete (it drops “GNU”); C and D are not the correct expansions.
- Q18. B.** Utility software performs maintenance and housekeeping tasks such as antivirus scanning, disk cleanup, and backup. A describes application software; C describes a compiler (programming software); D describes middleware.
- Q19. A.** Application software is divided into general-purpose (ready-made packages) and specific-purpose or custom software. B and C are other software groups or licensing terms, not the two kinds of application software; D is not a standard classification.
- Q20. B.** Open-source software makes its source code available under a licence, so this pair is correct. A wrongly says proprietary source is openly available; C wrongly says freeware must be paid for; D wrongly says shareware never requires payment.